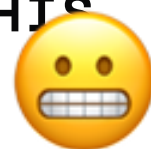


You need an update
from the devs,
without sounding
like you're
hovering.

A PROMPTING TECHNIQUE FOR EXACTLY THIS
SWIPE →



UNSENT DRAFT, TAKE 4

Hey, sorry to chase, but I was
wondering if maybe ~~the checkout fix~~
~~is~~
Hi! Quick one, no rush at all,
unless|



YOUR PROMPT

Write a Slack message asking the devs if the checkout issue is fixed.



you 9:41

Hey team! 🙌

Quick question about the checkout page performance issue we've been tracking. Has the slow loading problem been resolved?

Specifically:

- Are the recent optimisations addressing the page load time?
- Have we seen any improvements in our performance metrics?
- If it's not fixed, what's the current status and expected timeline?

Would appreciate an update when you have a moment. Thanks!

The bare prompt gets you a four-paragraph **memo** with bullet points and a deadline request. Would you send that? Neither would we.

Add a **second part** to the prompt: how it should sound, and how long it should be.

YOUR PROMPT

Write a Slack message to the development team asking about the status of the checkout page slow loading issue.

Tone: friendly, warm, collaborative, confident.

Style: 1 to 2 sentences, conversational Slack style, direct ask for current status or ETA, end with a brief thanks. |



Part one says what you need. Part two decides how it lands in the channel.



you 9:43

Hey team! 🙌 Checking in on the checkout page fix: is there a status or rough ETA?
Thanks so much!



dev team 9:47

Deploying the fix this afternoon! 🎉

Now the output is two sentences you'd happily send: a friendly check-in, a clear ask, a thank you. **Same request,** **different instructions**, entirely different message.

The **four levers**, for any message where tone could go wrong:



tone

State it explicitly:
formal or casual, peer
or mentor.



audience

Name who it's for;
depth and jargon
follow.



sample

Show a sample of your
writing to mirror.



length

Specify it: "2
sentences", "3
paragraphs", " $\leq$ 200
words".

They work in every chat assistant: ChatGPT,
Claude.ai, Gemini.

What tone and style **can do**, and what they can't:



Make the output **sound like you**.
Keep your messages **consistent**.



Reduce **factual errors**. A message can sound exactly like you and still be wrong.

Checking the facts is a separate skill (and a separate post).

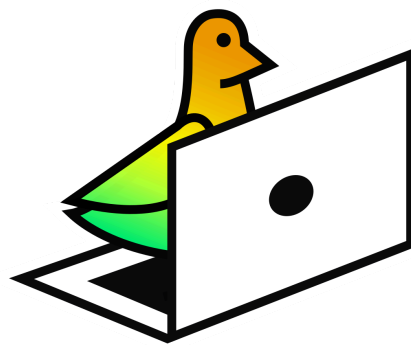
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07 / 07

Status nudges, reminders, feedback asks:
they all yield to this technique. Practise it in
the free first challenge of **Write Better with
AI: Prompting Foundations for Product
Managers.**

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First challenge free 🧡



Save this for the next message you keep
redrafting. 📌